

BABS1201 Assessment Topics

1. **Water was both essential and a barrier to early life on Earth – microdroplets are one potential solution to this paradox.**

Relates to course content: Life.

<https://theconversation.com/water-was-both-essential-and-a-barrier-to-early-life-on-earth-microdroplets-are-one-potential-solution-to-this-paradox-192710>

2. **The Most Complete Digital Replica of a Living Cell Yet Grows Like the Real Thing.**

Relates to course content: Cells.

<https://singularityhub.com/2022/02/27/the-most-complete-digital-replica-of-a-living-cell-yet-works-like-the-real-thing/>

3. **Strange microorganism under the sea may be missing link in evolution.**

Relates to course content: Cells.

<https://theconversation.com/strange-microorganism-under-the-sea-may-be-missing-link-in-evolution-41445>

4. **Why are there so many drugs to kill bacteria, but so few to tackle viruses?**

Related to course content: Cells.

<https://theconversation.com/why-are-there-so-many-drugs-to-kill-bacteria-but-so-few-to-tackle-viruses-137480>

5. **How does RNA know where to go in the city of the cell? Using cellular ZIP codes and postal carrier routes**

Relates to course content: Cellular transport/ genetics

<https://theconversation.com/how-does-rna-know-where-to-go-in-the-city-of-the-cell-using-cellular-zip-codes-and-postal-carrier-routes-191155>

6. AI-powered predictions show proteins finding their shapes.

Relates to course content: Macromolecules- protein.

https://www.science.org/content/article/breakthrough-2021#section_breakthrough

7. Science or Snake Oil: is A2 milk better for you than regular cow's milk?

Related to course content: Macromolecules- protein.

<https://theconversation.com/science-or-snake-oil-is-a2-milk-better-for-you-than-regular-cows-milk-62486>

8. Running gels and protein powders can be convenient boosts for athletes – but be sure to read the label.

Related to course content: Macromolecules- protein.

<https://theconversation.com/running-gels-and-protein-powders-can-be-convenient-boosts-for-athletes-but-be-sure-to-read-the-label-200730>

9. Why we can't spin a silken yarn as strong as a spider can?

Related to course content: Macromolecules- protein.

<https://theconversation.com/why-we-cant-spin-a-silken-yarn-as-strong-as-a-spider-can-71003>

10. Sea otters demonstrate that there is more to muscle than just movement – it can also bring the heat.

Relates to course content: Metabolism.

<https://theconversation.com/sea-otters-demonstrate-that-there-is-more-to-muscle-than-just-movement-it-can-also-bring-the-heat-165804>

11. Why are bigger animals more energy-efficient? A new answer to a centuries-old biological puzzle.

Relates to course content: Metabolism.

<https://theconversation.com/why-are-bigger-animals-more-energy-efficient-a-new-answer-to-a-centuries-old-biological-puzzle-188724>

12. Burn, baby, burn: the new science of metabolism.

Relates to course: Metabolism.

<https://www.theguardian.com/science/2021/oct/30/burn-baby-burn-the-new-science-of-metabolism>

13. Ever wonder how your body turns food into fuel? We tracked atoms to find out.

Relates to course: Metabolism.

<https://theconversation.com/ever-wonder-how-your-body-turns-food-into-fuel-we-tracked-atoms-to-find-out-211047>

14. Space colonies: how artificial photosynthesis may be key to sustained life beyond Earth.

Relates to course content: Photosynthesis.

<https://theconversation.com/space-colonies-how-artificial-photosynthesis-may-be-key-to-sustained-life-beyond-earth-206942>

15. Sea slug steals genes for greens, makes chlorophyll like a plant.

Relates to course content: Genetics/ Photosynthesis.

<https://www.sciencenews.org/article/sea-slug-steals-genes-greens-makes-chlorophyll-plant>

16. Latest DNA Analysis Shows The Yeti Are Actually Just a Bunch of Bears

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://www.sciencealert.com/dna-analysis-yeti-samples-asian-bears-no-proof-of-cryptids>

17. Bringing back the woolly mammoth and other extinct creatures may be impossible.

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://www.science.org/content/article/bringing-back-woolly-mammoth-and-other-extinct-creatures-may-be-impossible>

18. New research reveals that Ötzi the iceman was bald and probably from a farming family – what else can DNA uncover?

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://theconversation.com/new-research-reveals-that-otzi-the-iceman-was-bald-and-probably-from-a-farming-family-what-else-can-dna-uncover-211799>

19. How your genes may determine whether you can be an endurance athlete.

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://theconversation.com/how-your-genes-may-determine-whether-you-can-be-an-endurance-athlete-210426>

20. You shed DNA everywhere you go – trace samples in the water, sand and air are enough to identify who you are, raising ethical questions about privacy.

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://theconversation.com/you-shed-dna-everywhere-you-go-trace-samples-in-the-water-sand-and-air-are-enough-to-identify-who-you-are-raising-ethical-questions-about-privacy-205557>

21. How immortal jellyfish turn back time.

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://theconversation.com/how-immortal-jellyfish-turn-back-time-197304>

22. Picky eater? Research shows it could be in your DNA.

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://theconversation.com/picky-eater-research-shows-it-could-be-in-your-dna-189810>

23. The 'weird' male Y chromosome has finally been fully sequenced. Can we now understand how it works, and how it evolved?

Related to course content: Genetics.

<https://theconversation.com/the-weird-male-y-chromosome-has-finally-been-fully-sequenced-can-we-now-understand-how-it-works-and-how-it-evolved-212112>

24. Why are tall people more likely to get cancer? What we know, don't know and suspect.

Related to course content: Genetics / metabolism.

<https://theconversation.com/why-are-tall-people-more-likely-to-get-cancer-what-we-know-dont-know-and-suspect-235525>

25. The once-in-an-eon event that gave earth plants has happened again.

Related to course content: Cell structure and function / metabolism

https://www.iflscience.com/the-once-in-an-eon-event-that-gave-earth-plants-has-happened-again-73878?fbclid=IwY2xjawJw1KZleHRuA2FlbQlxMAABHtoQoCfGGsfhjSSSIZGon6clcr2pQtKgp01u46Ei-PhHQViQaSeEB-jpzKfQ_aem_rxRjzJWUQmL0QVqkfiu4WQ